Report structure and content for your HCI assessment

Student Planner: An Interactive Prototype Applying HCI Principles

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Table Of Content

1. Title and introduction 3
2. Application concept 3
2.1 Background and justification 3
2.2 Main objectives and intended features 3
3. Target users 4
3.1 Primary user groups 4
3.2 Users' problems and how the application addresses them 4
4. User interaction storyboard and application comparison 4
4.1 User storyboard 4
4.2 Comparison with Existing Application: Google Calendar 6
5. Interactive prototype 7
5.1 Tool and main screens 7
5.2 Interactive elements and workflows 9
5.3 Consistency (layout, typography, colour, navigation) 10
5.4 HCI design principles (how your prototype applies them) 11
6. Conclusion 11

1. Title and introduction

Student Planner web application. It helps users view their weekly schedule, track deadlines, add tasks with priority and notes, and manage profile and preferences. The prototype is implemented as an HTML/CSS interactive prototype and is designed using user-centred design and HCI principles.

User problem	How the Student Planner addresses it
Forgetting assignment due dates	Upcoming Deadlines section on the dashboard with clear due dates (HCI Assignment – Due 25 March”).
Losing track of weekly class times	This Week’s Schedule shows each weekday and class/time (“Monday: HCI 10am–12pm”).
Scattered notes and priorities	Add Task with title, course, due date, priority (Low/Medium/High), and notes.
Needing one place for schedule + tasks	Single app with Dashboard (schedule + deadlines), Add Task, and Profile.
Wanting reminders and preferences	Profile & Settings: email reminders checkbox, dark mode toggle (visual in prototype).
Using phone between classes	Mobile-friendly layout, bottom navigation, touch-friendly buttons and cards.

2. Application concept

2.1 Background and justification

- Problem: Students juggle multiple courses, assignments, and deadlines paper planners and generic apps often don’t combine schedule + tasks + preferences in one place.
- Justification: A dedicated Student Planner focuses on (1) weekly timetable, (2) upcoming deadlines, and (3) task creation with course, date, and priority all in a single, consistent interface. Choosing a student planner is relevant for HCI because it involves clear user groups, frequent daily use, and need for usability and accessibility.

2.2 Main objectives and intended features

Objectives:

- Allow students to see their weekly schedule at a glance (Mon–Fri with class names and times).
- Surface upcoming deadlines so nothing is missed.
- Let users add tasks with title, course, due date, priority (Low/Medium/High), and notes.
- Provide profile and settings (dark mode, email reminders) and a clear way to log out.

Intended features (map to your prototype):

Feature	How it appears in the prototype
Authentication	Login page (email, password, Login button; Sign Up link)
Dashboard	“Welcome back, Alex!”, This Week’s Schedule (Mon–Fri), Upcoming Deadlines (3 cards)
Add task	Form: Task title, Course name, Due date, Priority (radio), Notes, Add Task, Cancel
Profile & settings	Profile info (name, email), Dark mode ON/OFF, Email reminders checkbox, Logout
Navigation	Bottom nav: Home, Add Task, Profile; “Back to Login” on app screens

3. Target users

3.1 Primary user groups

- Primary: University or college students (full-time or part-time) who have multiple modules, assignments, and exams.
- Secondary: High school students or anyone managing course-based schedules and deadlines.

3.2 Users’ problems and how the application addresses them

4. User interaction storyboard and application comparison

4.1 User storyboard

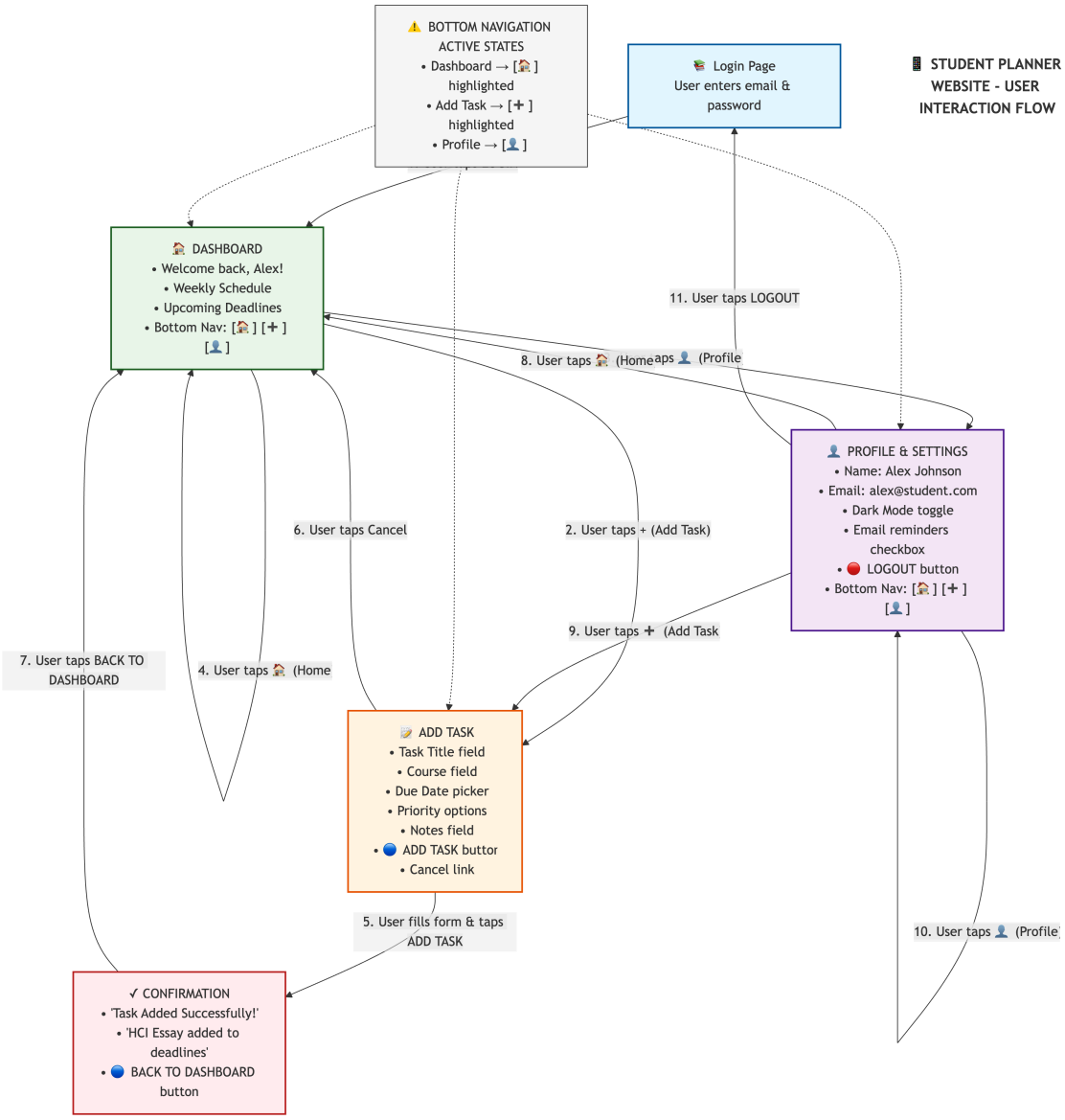
Describe a single scenario (“Alex checks the week and adds a new assignment”) and break it into steps. You can illustrate with simple frames/sketches or a table.

Example flow:

1. Frame 1 – Login: User opens app, sees **Student Planner**, enters email and password, taps Login.
2. Frame 2 – Dashboard: System shows “Welcome back, Alex!”, This Week’s Schedule (Mon–Fri), and Upcoming Deadlines (HCI, Math, Programming).
3. Frame 3 – Add task: User taps Add Task in bottom nav → sees “Add New Task” form. Fills title (“HCI Essay”), course, due date, selects High priority, adds notes.
4. Frame 4 – Submit: User taps Add Task → (in storyboard you can say they return to dashboard or see confirmation).
5. Frame 5 – Profile: User taps Profile → sees name, email, Dark Mode, Email reminders; can tap Logout to return to login.

System responses to include:

- Login → navigate to Dashboard.
- Tap “Add Task” → show Add Task screen.
- Tap “Add Task” button → (describe intended feedback, return to Dashboard).
- Tap “Cancel” → return to Dashboard.
- Tap “Profile” / “Home” → change screen; active state in bottom nav (Home highlighted on Dashboard).



4.2 Comparison with Existing Application: Google Calendar

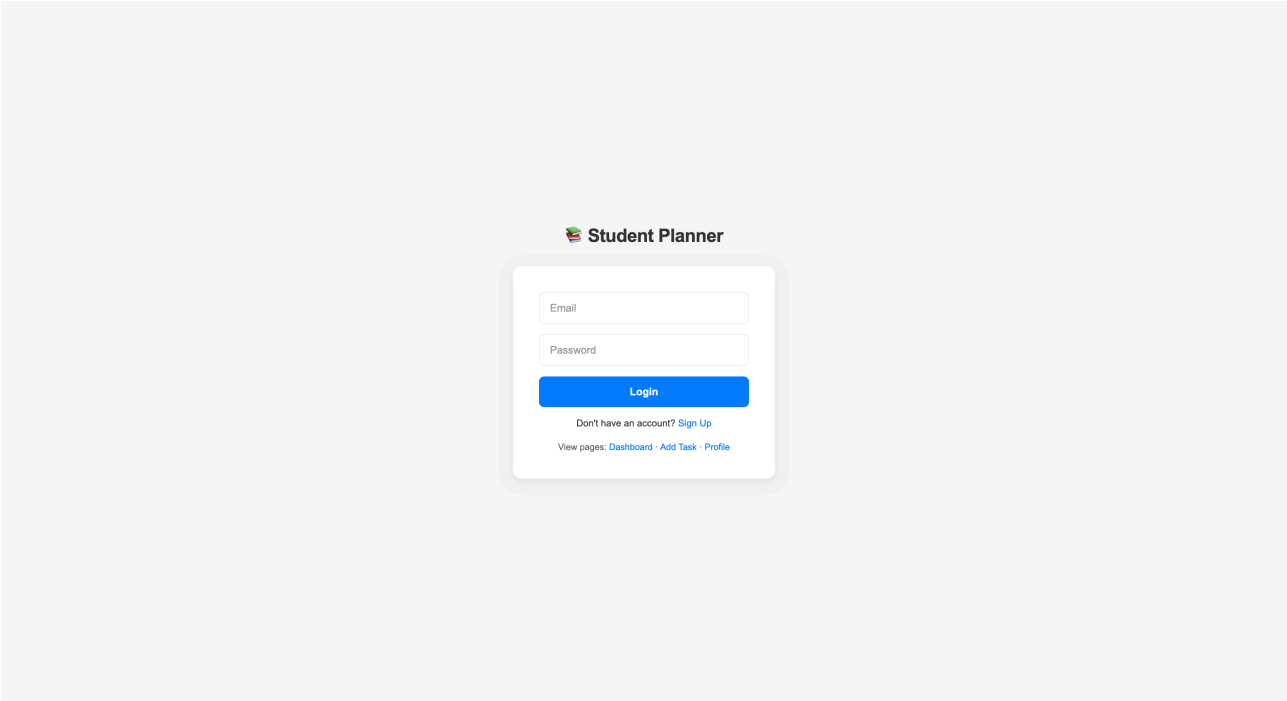
Aspect	Google Calendar	Student Planner Website (Your Design)
Similarity	Both show schedule and support tasks/events with dates.	Both show schedule and support tasks/events with dates.
Task Visibility	Tasks/events hidden inside calendar view; requires clicking to see details.	Dedicated "Upcoming Deadlines" list on main dashboard – visible immediately without extra clicks.
Task Entry Form	Separate event creation form; limited fields (title, date, time).	Task-centric Add form with course, priority, and notes in one place – matches student thinking: "assignment for HCI, high priority".
Navigation	Top menu or sidebar; varies across devices.	Consistent bottom navigation (Home / Add Task / Profile) – core actions always one tap away, especially mobile-friendly.
First Screen Usability	Shows calendar grid; deadlines not visible until you click a date.	Simpler first screen – Dashboard shows weekly schedule + deadlines immediately after login, reducing steps to get most important information.

5. Interactive prototype

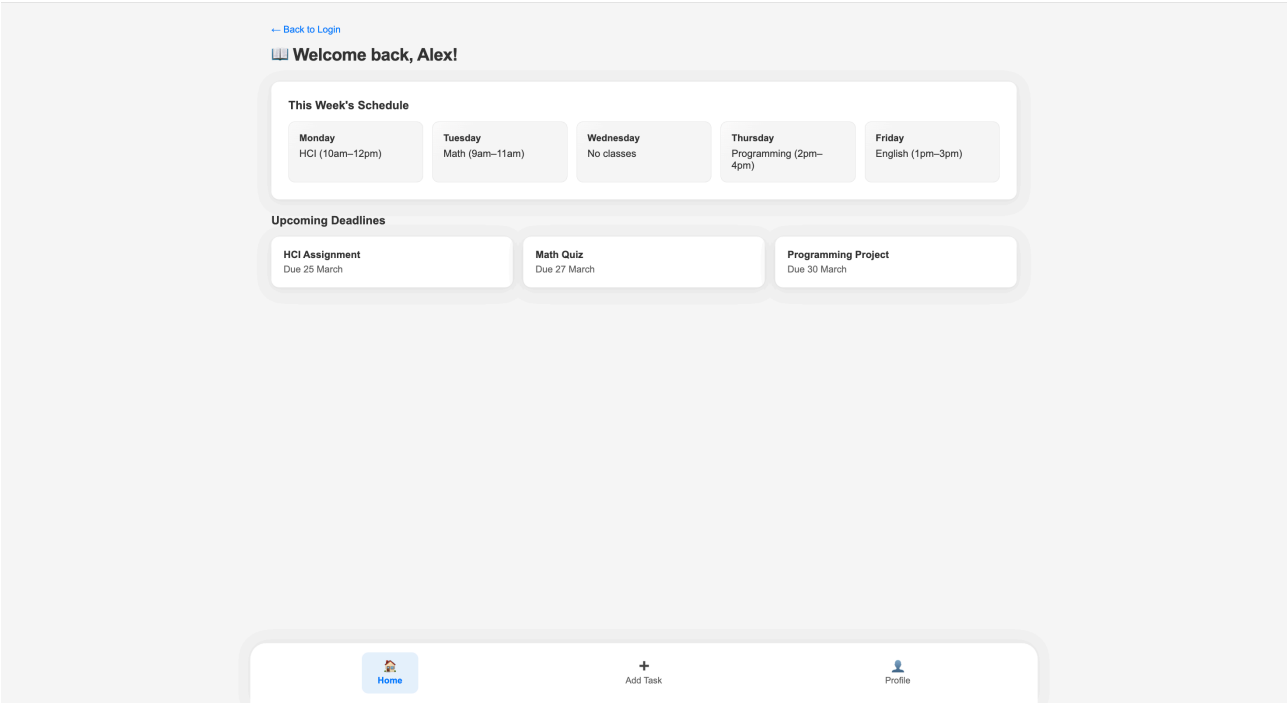
5.1 Tool and main screens

- Tool: HTML, CSS, and optional minimal JavaScript (or “static HTML/CSS prototype”).

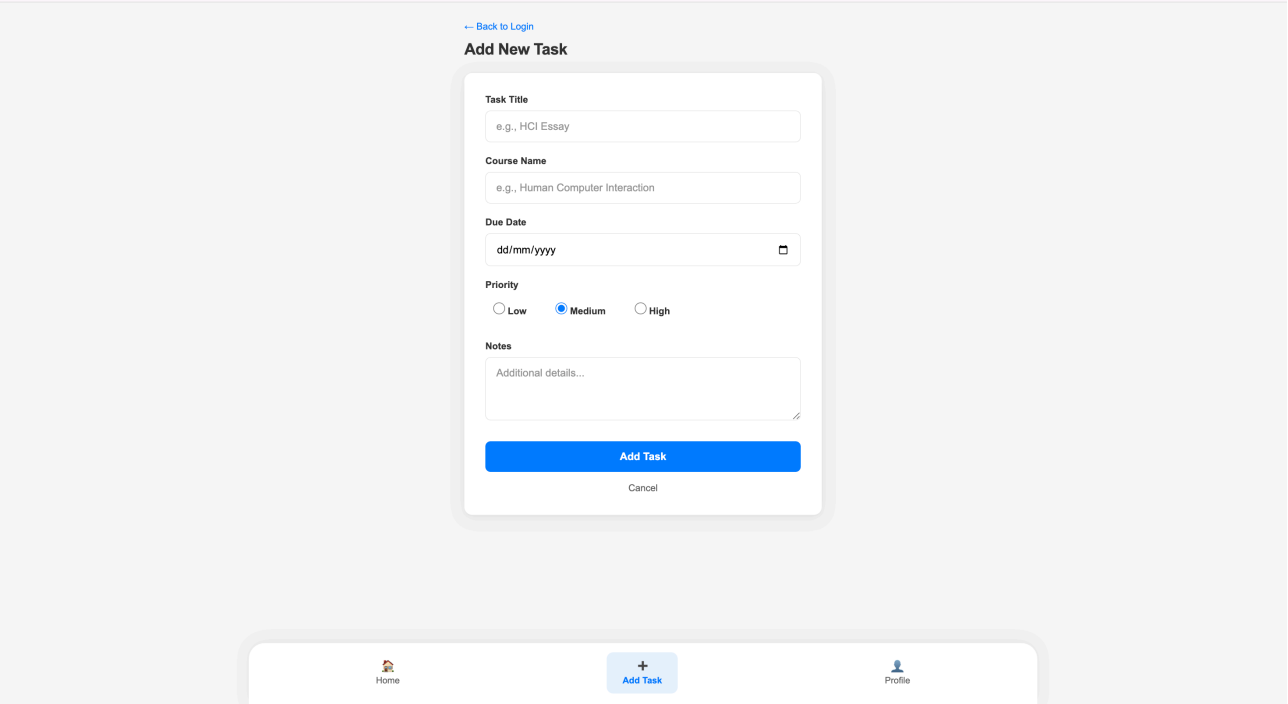
1. Login – index.html



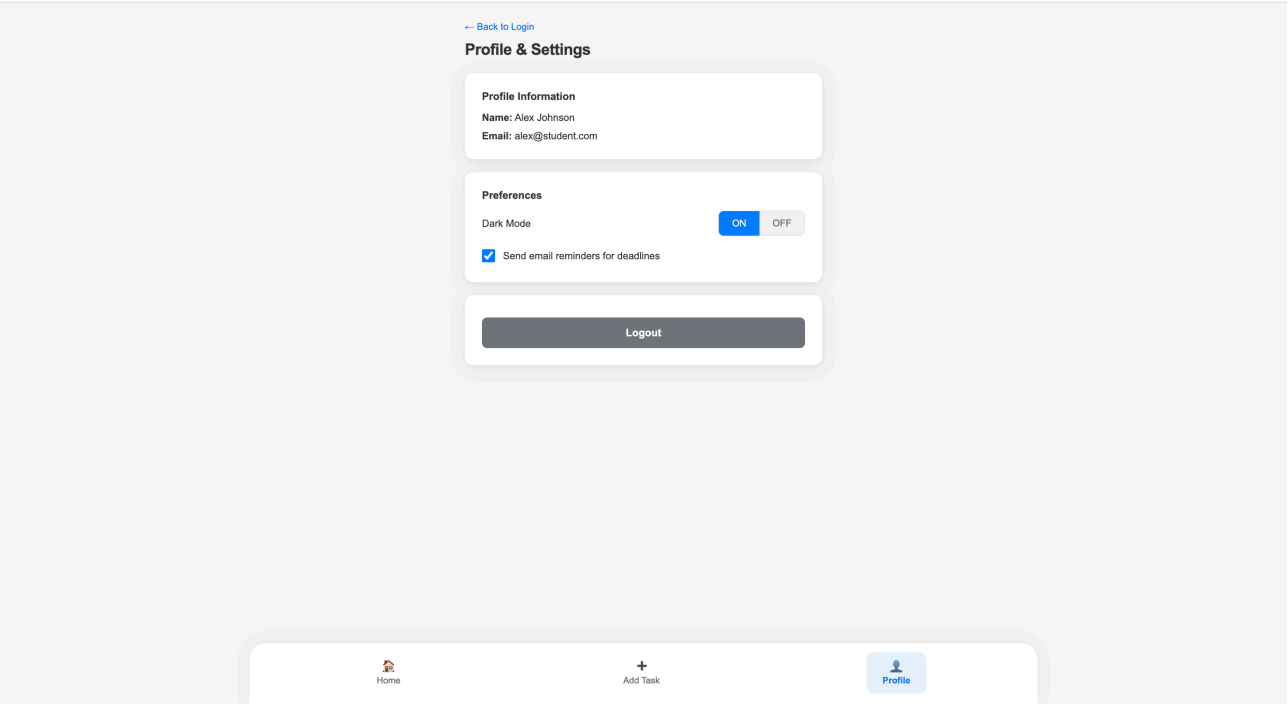
2. Dashboard (Home) – dashboard.html (timetable + deadlines)



3. Add Task – add-task.html

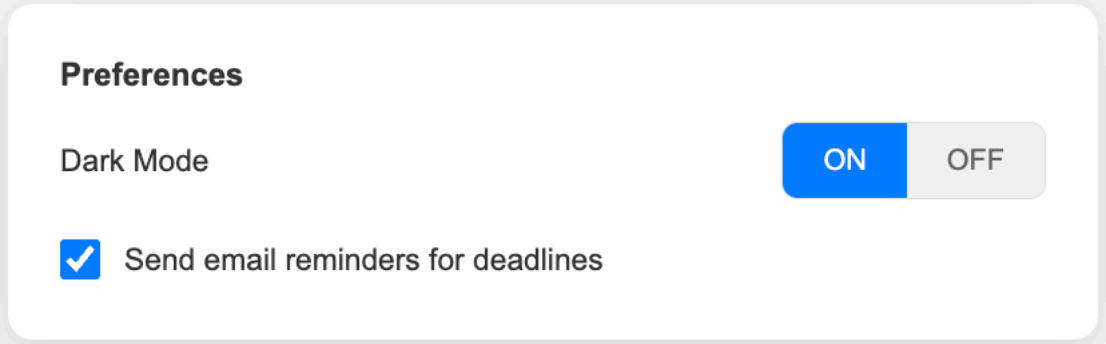


4. Profile & Settings – profile.html

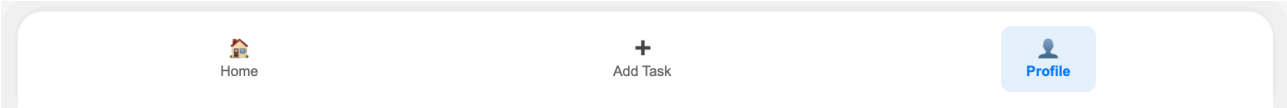


5.2 Interactive elements and workflows

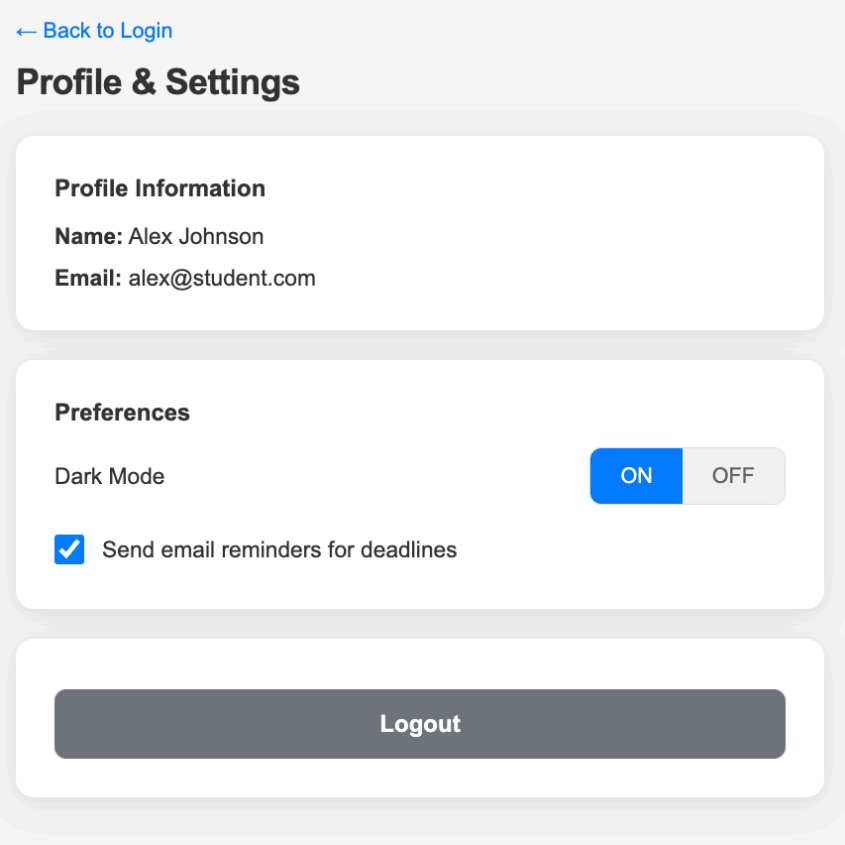
- Buttons: Login, Add Task (submit), Logout, Dark Mode ON/OFF, Cancel (link).



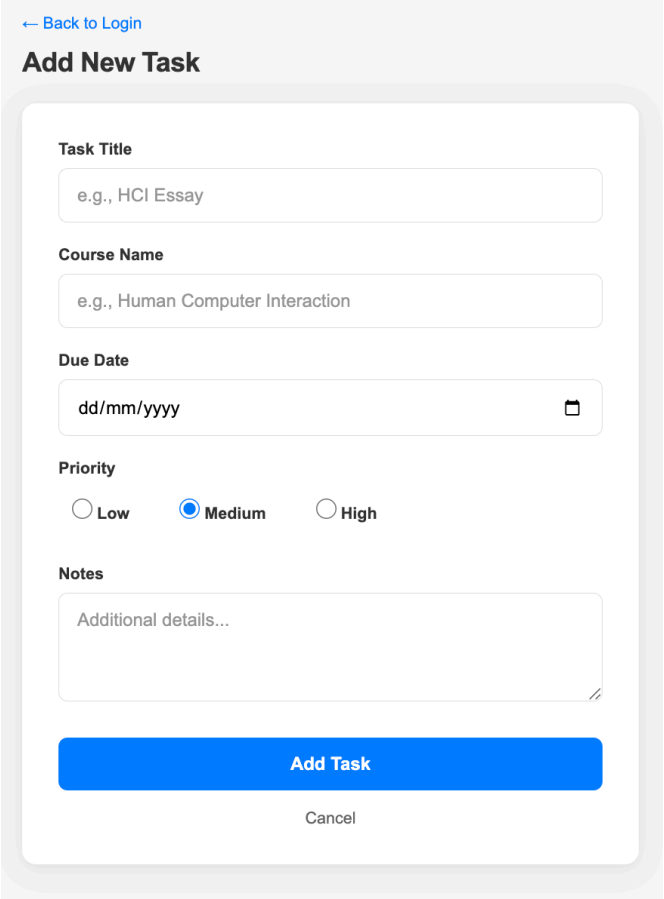
- Navigation: Bottom nav (Home, Add Task, Profile) “Back to Login” “View pages: Dashboard · Add Task · Profile” on login (for demo).



- Forms: Email, password; task title, course, due date (date input), priority (radio), notes (textarea); checkbox for email reminders.



- Workflows: Login → Dashboard; Dashboard ↔ Add Task ↔ Profile via bottom nav; Add Task → Cancel → Dashboard; Profile → Logout → (conceptually) Login.

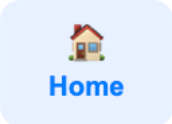


5.3 Consistency (layout, typography, colour, navigation)

- Layout: Same bottom nav on Dashboard, Add Task, Profile same **Back to Login** placement consistent card layout (white cards, rounded corners, shadow).

- Typography: Arial throughout clear hierarchy (page title, section titles, body).

- Navigation: Same three items in the same order in the bottom bar active state ("Home" on Dashboard).



5.4 HCI design principles (how your prototype applies them)

Principle	Application in the prototype
Usability	Few steps to reach schedule and deadlines (login → dashboard) clear labels (**Task Title**, **Course Name**, **Due Date**, **Priority**) simple language (**This Week's Schedule**, **Upcoming Deadlines**).
Feedback	Buttons have hover states (lift, colour change), focus states on inputs (blue border/outline) active state on bottom nav (highlighted item) optional add a one-line note that **Add Task** could show a success message in a full implementation.
Affordance	Buttons look clickable (solid fill, rounded corners) links look like links (blue, underline on hover) inputs have visible borders and placeholders icons (🏠, ➕, 👤) suggest Home, Add, Profile.
Error prevention	Required email and password on login placeholder examples (HCI Essay, Human Computer Interaction) date picker for due date to avoid invalid dates single **Cancel** to leave the form without submitting.
Accessibility	Semantic HTML (**<main>**, **<section>**, **<nav>**, **<label for="...">**) sufficient contrast (dark text on light background) touch-friendly targets (padding on buttons and nav) prefers-reduced-motion in CSS for animations mobile-friendly viewport and layout.

6. Conclusion

The Student Planner Website was built to solve a simple but common problem: helping students keep track of their classes, assignments, and deadlines all in one place. Using basic HTML and CSS, a working prototype was created with four main screens—Login, Dashboard, Add Task, and Profile.

Throughout the design process, key HCI principles like Fitts' Law, consistency, feedback, and affordance were kept in mind. Buttons are sized and placed for easy clicking, colors and fonts stay the same across pages, and the bottom navigation bar makes moving between screens simple and familiar. Small touches like a date picker help prevent errors, and the layout works well on mobile devices.

When compared to a tool like Google Calendar, this design stands out by putting deadlines front and center, offering a task form that matches how students actually think, and keeping navigation consistent and easy to reach.